



THE PROPERTY INCIDENT & LOSS RECORD KIT

Document it before you need to prove it.

When something happens to the property - storm, water, fire, failure, or damage of any kind - this kit keeps the factual record: what happened, when, what it looked like, what was done, what it cost.

INCIDENT RECORDS - 2026

How to Use This Kit

An incident is anything that damages or threatens the property: a storm, a burst pipe, a fallen tree, an appliance failure, damage during work on the home, a utility problem. Whatever it is, the facts of it fade fast - and the record you keep in the first days is the record you will have forever.

This kit works for any incident, whether or not an insurance claim, warranty request, or any other process ever follows. Its only job is the factual record: dates, photographs, actions, costs, conversations, documents.

START THE CHRONOLOGY THE DAY YOU NOTICE.

The first entry is the most valuable line in the whole record: what you saw, when, and what you did next.

PHOTOGRAPH BEFORE YOU TOUCH ANYTHING.

Then photograph again after any cleanup or protective step. Both states matter; only one of them is available later.

LOG EVERY CONVERSATION THE SAME DAY.

Who, when, how, and what was said - in your own words, dated. Memory is not a communications log.

READ THIS FIRST

This kit is a documentation and organization tool for your own records. It is not legal or insurance advice, does not interpret any policy or contract, does not determine coverage, fault, or liability, and does not tell you what any outcome should be. It preserves facts. Decisions about any claim, dispute, or repair belong with you and the licensed professionals you choose.

The Incident Record

One card per incident: what happened, when it was first noticed, where, and what was done immediately. Number each incident and carry the number onto every page that follows.

IN THIS SECTION

- Incident cards
- First-noticed facts
- Immediate actions taken

Incident Card 1

INCIDENT 1

WHAT HAPPENED (SHORT DESCRIPTION)

DATE / TIME FIRST NOTICED

NOTICED BY

WEATHER / CONDITIONS

LOCATION(S) IN / ON PROPERTY

APPARENT SOURCE (AS OBSERVED, NOT CONCLUDED)

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS TAKEN (SAME DAY)

OTHERS PRESENT / AWARE

FIRST PHOTOS TAKEN (DATE/TIME)

STATUS:

ACTIVE []

STABILIZED []

REPAIRED []

CLOSED []

First-day notes

Incident Card 2

INCIDENT 2

WHAT HAPPENED (SHORT DESCRIPTION)

DATE / TIME FIRST NOTICEDNOTICED BYWEATHER / CONDITIONS

LOCATION(S) IN / ON PROPERTY

APPARENT SOURCE (AS OBSERVED, NOT CONCLUDED)

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS TAKEN (SAME DAY)

OTHERS PRESENT / AWAREFIRST PHOTOS TAKEN (DATE/TIME)

STATUS: ACTIVE []STABILIZED []REPAIRED []CLOSED []

First-day notes

Incident Card 3

INCIDENT 3

WHAT HAPPENED (SHORT DESCRIPTION)

DATE / TIME FIRST NOTICED

NOTICED BY

WEATHER / CONDITIONS

LOCATION(S) IN / ON PROPERTY

APPARENT SOURCE (AS OBSERVED, NOT CONCLUDED)

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS TAKEN (SAME DAY)

OTHERS PRESENT / AWARE

FIRST PHOTOS TAKEN (DATE/TIME)

STATUS:

ACTIVE []

STABILIZED []

REPAIRED []

CLOSED []

First-day notes

The Chronology

The running dated log of everything: what happened, what you observed, what you did, who was involved. The chronology is the backbone every other page hangs from.

IN THIS SECTION

- Dated running entries
- Observations vs. actions
- Reference to photos & documents

Chronology - Page 1

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Chronology - Page 2

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Chronology - Page 3

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Chronology - Page 4

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Chronology - Page 5

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Chronology - Page 6

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Chronology - Page 7

DATE / TIME	INC #	WHAT HAPPENED / WHAT YOU OBSERVED / WHAT YOU DID	PHOTO / DOC REF

Damage Documentation

Area by area: what is damaged, what it looks like, and the photographs that show it. Describe what you can see and measure - the record speaks in observations.

IN THIS SECTION

- Per-area damage register
- Photo confirmation
- Measurements & counts

Damage Register - Page 1

AREA / ITEM	INC #	DAMAGE OBSERVED (DESCRIBE & MEASURE)	PHOTOS	DATE DOC'D

Damage Register - Page 2

AREA / ITEM	INC #	DAMAGE OBSERVED (DESCRIBE & MEASURE)	PHOTOS	DATE DOC'D

Damage Register - Page 3

AREA / ITEM	INC #	DAMAGE OBSERVED (DESCRIBE & MEASURE)	PHOTOS	DATE DOC'D

Damage Register - Page 4

AREA / ITEM	INC #	DAMAGE OBSERVED (DESCRIBE & MEASURE)	PHOTOS	DATE DOC'D

Damage Register - Page 5

AREA / ITEM	INC #	DAMAGE OBSERVED (DESCRIBE & MEASURE)	PHOTOS	DATE DOC'D

Contents Affected

Personal property affected by the incident - item by item, with its condition described and photographed. If you keep Kit 1, note the inventory page each item appears on.

ITEM	INC #	CONDITION OBSERVED	PHOTOS	KIT 1 REF	DISPOSITION (KEPT/DI

Mitigation Record

The protective steps taken to keep things from getting worse - tarps, water extraction, board-ups, shutoffs - each one dated, photographed, and priced.

IN THIS SECTION

- Action log with dates
- Costs & receipts
- Before / after photo confirmation

Protective Actions - Page 1

DATE	INC #	ACTION TAKEN	BY WHOM	COST	RECEIPT WHERE	PHOTOS

Protective Actions - Page 2

DATE	INC #	ACTION TAKEN	BY WHOM	COST	RECEIPT WHERE	PHOTOS

People & Estimates

Everyone who looks at the damage, and every number they put on paper - recorded with what each estimate actually covers.

IN THIS SECTION

- Contact register
- Estimate record cards
- Scope of each estimate

Contact Register

NAME	ROLE / COMPANY	PHONE / EMAIL	FIRST CONTACT	REF / FILE #

Estimate Cards - Page 1

ESTIMATE 1

COMPANY	DATE	INC #
SCOPE - WHAT THIS ESTIMATE COVERS		
AMOUNT	WRITTEN COPY? (Y/N)	KEPT WHERE

ESTIMATE 2

COMPANY	DATE	INC #
SCOPE - WHAT THIS ESTIMATE COVERS		
AMOUNT	WRITTEN COPY? (Y/N)	KEPT WHERE

Estimate Cards - Page 2

ESTIMATE 3

COMPANY	DATE	INC #
SCOPE - WHAT THIS ESTIMATE COVERS		
AMOUNT	WRITTEN COPY? (Y/N)	KEPT WHERE

ESTIMATE 4

COMPANY	DATE	INC #
SCOPE - WHAT THIS ESTIMATE COVERS		
AMOUNT	WRITTEN COPY? (Y/N)	KEPT WHERE

Expense Log

Every dollar the incident costs you out of pocket, from tarps to hotel nights - dated, itemized, and tied to a receipt location.

IN THIS SECTION

- Out-of-pocket log
- Receipt locations
- Running totals

Out-of-Pocket Expenses - Page 1

DATE	INC #	EXPENSE	PURPOSE	AMOUNT	RECEIPT WHERE

PAGE TOTAL _____

Out-of-Pocket Expenses - Page 2

DATE	INC #	EXPENSE	PURPOSE	AMOUNT	RECEIPT WHERE

PAGE TOTAL _____

Out-of-Pocket Expenses - Page 3

DATE	INC #	EXPENSE	PURPOSE	AMOUNT	RECEIPT WHERE

PAGE TOTAL _____

Communications Log

Every call, message, email, letter, and visit about the incident - who, when, how, and what was said, written the same day in your own words.

IN THIS SECTION

- Dated communications entries
- Method & participants
- Follow-ups promised & received

Communications - Page 1

DATE	WITH WHOM / ORG	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID (SUMMARY)	FOLLOW-UP PROMISED

Communications - Page 2

DATE	WITH WHOM / ORG	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID (SUMMARY)	FOLLOW-UP PROMISED

Communications - Page 3

DATE	WITH WHOM / ORG	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID (SUMMARY)	FOLLOW-UP PROMISED

Communications - Page 4

DATE	WITH WHOM / ORG	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID (SUMMARY)	FOLLOW-UP PROMISED

Communications - Page 5

DATE	WITH WHOM / ORG	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID (SUMMARY)	FOLLOW-UP PROMISED

Communications - Page 6

DATE	WITH WHOM / ORG	HOW	WHAT WAS SAID (SUMMARY)	FOLLOW-UP PROMISED

Repair Record

How the property was put back: the work performed, by whom, at what cost - and the paper that proves completion.

IN THIS SECTION

- Repair log
- Completion facts
- Warranty on repairs

Repairs - Page 1

DATE	INC #	WORK PERFORMED / WHERE	BY WHOM	COST	INVOICE WHERE	PHOTOS

Repairs - Page 2

DATE	INC #	WORK PERFORMED / WHERE	BY WHOM	COST	INVOICE WHERE	PHOTOS

Completion & Warranty

INCIDENT 1 - REPAIR COMPLETION

COMPLETED (DATE)	TOTAL REPAIR COST	FINAL WALKTHROUGH WITH
WARRANTY ON REPAIRS (TERM / ENDS)	WARRANTY DOC KEPT WHERE	

INCIDENT 2 - REPAIR COMPLETION

COMPLETED (DATE)	TOTAL REPAIR COST	FINAL WALKTHROUGH WITH
WARRANTY ON REPAIRS (TERM / ENDS)	WARRANTY DOC KEPT WHERE	

After photos taken

- ☐ Every repaired area photographed after completion
- ☐ Repaired-area photos filed to the incident album

Supporting Document Index

The master list of every document the incident produced - numbered, dated, described, and locatable in under a minute.

IN THIS SECTION

- Numbered document index
- Source & date
- Physical / digital location

Document Index - Page 1

DOC #	INC #	DESCRIPTION	DATE	SOURCE	KEPT WHERE

Document Index - Page 2

DOC #	INC #	DESCRIPTION	DATE	SOURCE	KEPT WHERE

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Closing the Incident

When it's over, close the record deliberately: totals, final status, what the master property record needs to inherit, and what you'd document sooner next time.

IN THIS SECTION

- Incident close-out
- Master-record updates
- Notes to your future self

Incident Close-Out

INCIDENT 1 - CLOSED

CLOSED (DATE)	TOTAL OUT-OF-POCKET	TOTAL REPAIR COST
FINAL STATUS / RESOLUTION (FACTUAL)		
FULL FILE SCANNED & STORED AT		

INCIDENT 2 - CLOSED

CLOSED (DATE)	TOTAL OUT-OF-POCKET	TOTAL REPAIR COST
FINAL STATUS / RESOLUTION (FACTUAL)		
FULL FILE SCANNED & STORED AT		

Master property record updated

- ☐ Repairs copied to Kit 1 repair history
- ☐ New systems / items added to inventory & serial logs
- ☐ Warranty on repairs added to warranty tracker

Notes to Your Future Self

What you'd photograph sooner, log sooner, or keep differently next time. The best documentation habits come from the incident you just finished.

The First 48 Hours, In Order

If you open this kit mid-incident and read only one page, make it this one.

- 01 Make it safe for people first - property second, always.
- 02 Photograph everything as found, before touching anything.
- 03 Take reasonable protective steps; photograph after each one; keep every receipt.
- 04 Start the chronology: first entry today, in your own words.
- 05 Open an incident card and number it.
- 06 Log every conversation the day it happens.
- 07 Move the photos into a dated incident album tonight - and back them up off the property.

PLAIN-LANGUAGE NOTE

This kit is a documentation and organization tool for your own records. It is not legal or insurance advice, does not interpret policies or contracts, and does not determine coverage, fault, liability, or the outcome of any process. If an insurance claim or dispute follows your incident, the decisions in it are yours and your chosen licensed professionals'.

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